

ILLEGAL, UNREPORTED AND UNREGULATED FISHING

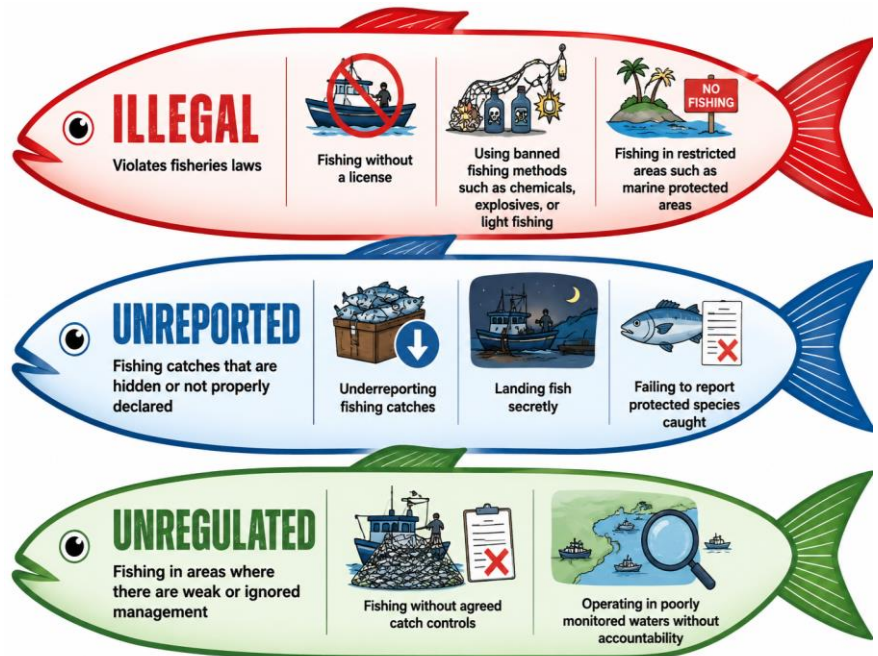
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The Hidden Faces of IUU Fishing

What Constitutes Illegal, Unreported and Unregulated (IUU) Fishing?

Illegal, Unreported and Unregulated (IUU) fishing is one of the biggest threats to sustainable fisheries and coastal livelihoods across West Africa. Many people assume that IUU fishing only involves large foreign trawlers operating offshore. However, IUU fishing can happen at all levels of fishing, including small-scale / artisanal fisheries – whenever fishing activities break fisheries laws or ignore management rules.

IUU fishing constitutes any fishing activity that is:



Together Against IUU Fishing

IUU fishing affects everyone along the fisheries value chain. Women are especially affected because declining fish stocks resulting from IUU fishing directly impact fish processing and trading activities that support many household incomes.

Addressing IUU fishing therefore requires shared responsibility among governments, fishers, coastal communities, researchers, and consumers. Combating IUU fishing is not solely achieved at sea through enforcement. It also requires informed communities, responsible fishing practices, and inclusive participation.

WASMaN is committed to contributing to efforts towards curbing IUU Fishing through:

- Educating coastal communities on fisheries regulations and sustainable fishing practices
- Supporting community-based monitoring and reporting of illegal fishing activities
- Promoting ocean stewardship and marine conservation among young people.